The gentlewoman's gentlewoman

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/52907695.

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by Bagge

Summary

Turns out, even grown-ups can have crushes

Notes

This version of Angella and Juliet comes from The Frank's fic "Dork Diary" (which you totally should read). There are some mild spoilers. This scene takes place late at night December 22.

"All things considered, Miss Moon's Christmas party went well, Mrs Moon."

Juliet's voice was proper and polite, but there was nevertheless hidden undertones.

Angella looked up her from her favourite armchair, a bit too posh to be properly comfortable, in Juliet's opinion, but decent enough. She put a bookmark in her book (because the sun would grow cold and die before Angella Moon committed the atrocity of dog-earing a page of a book) and gave her cook (even if it was a long time ago that tile was an apt description of everything that Juliet did for the Moon family) a tired smile.

"As well as could be expected, I suppose."

"After I drove her friends home, was there any... difficulties in getting Miss Moon to pack for tomorrow?"

Angella gave Juliet a long suffering look.

"It went... about as well as could be expected," she said with a shudder.

"Is she still upset about going to her aunt over the holidays?"

"It's mostly performative, I think. However my daughter is quite the performer."

A quick smile passed Juliet's mouth but she didn't comment.

"My preparations are almost done," Angella said, as if she hadn't obsessed about what to pack for a week, and her bags being ready for the last three days.

"And the Lexus is ready," Juliet filled in. "I'll bring it to the front first thing in the morning. Everything is ready for the trip, Mrs Moon."

"We still need to prepare the house..." Angella begun with a worried look. "There are food that will spoil and the colour coordination of the east wing does not match the bushes, and the children did a MESS of the decorations in Glimmer's room, and..."

"The cleaning firm will take care of the food, the colour coordination is fine and the security detail will keep an eye on everything when we are gone," Juliet promised her. She leaned forward and looked her employer in the eyes. "And - just putting this thought out there, Mrs Moon - perhaps it's entirely detrimental for Miss Moon's development if her room is decorated by her friends one year, rather than her Interior Decorators?"

Angella made a little sound between a laugh and a sob.

"Juliet - be honest with me: Do I work myself up about nothing again?"

Juliet didn't try to hide her smile.

"One might draw that conclusion, Mrs Moon."

Angella breathed out in a huge huff.

"Good thing then that I have you to keep me straight." (She didn't see the pained expression that for a moment passed Juliet's features). "From now on I will be *chill*."

Angella sat up straight with a proud smile. After a few seconds her smile faltered. "Wait, did we ask the maids to check the mail?"

"Yes, Mrs Moon."

"And Glimmer's dance instructor is aware that she's away?"

"Yes, Mrs Moon."

"And the maintenance..."

"Everything is taken care of, Mrs Moon. Why don't you just relax?"

Angella clutched her book like a teddy bear and gave Juliet the panic struck look of someone who totally knows how to relax.

"I'll make you a mug of tea," Juliet promised and was rewarded with a look of utter gratitude from Angella.

"Um, Juliet?" Angella said as the cook was about to leave the living room, starting the long trek towards the kitchen. She turned in the door.

"Yes, Mrs Moon?"

"I know that you have a long day ahead of you tomorrow, but If you don't mind... could you perhaps make it two cups and... if you want to, perhaps make me... company?"

Juliet smiled, a heartfelt smile.

"I wouldn't mind that at all, Mrs Moon."

- - -

About half an hour later - because good tea can't be rushed - Angella and Juliet sipped their tea together. Angella had put her book to the side.

"Was there any difficulties in driving Glimmers friends back home?"

Juliet swallowed a small gulp of tea before answering.

"Not at all, Mrs Moon. They are most polite." She gave her employer a wry smile. "Although Miss Van Lepovski-West wishes to inform us that the carbon footprint of the Lexus leaves a lot to be desired."

Angella's face wrinkled in a worried frown.

"Micah always thought we should have converted to electric..."

"Mr Moon just wanted some new toys, if I may be so bold," Juliet snickered. "And if we did, you can bet Perfuma would just find inspiration to discuss the impact of lithium mines."

"I hope her passions don't lead to a conflict with Glimmer," Angela said, putting down her cup. "If Glimmer feels the need to defend my consumer habits she might..."

"It's OK," Juliet said. "If anything, Perfuma is the diplomat of their little clique."

"I guess... I'm truly grateful for Glimmer finally forming bonds in her own age. I just fear she is not... well versed to navigate the social dynamics of children her own age."

"No shit," Juliet mumbled in her tea.

"What was that?"

"I said that Miss Moon and her friends learn from each other. And despite their difference, they are all invested in preserving their friendship. They'll be fine."

Angella gave Juliet another look full of thank, her expression for a moment much more animated than the reserved facade she usually tried to present to the world.

"Thank you, Juliet," she whispered. "I'm so thankful Glimmer finally has widened her social circle. I just worry...."

Her voice trailed off. Juliet gave her a compassionate look.

"I know, Mrs Moon."

They sat in silence for a few moments. Angella had put both hands around the cup to warm her hands (they were always too cold, Juliet knew).

"It took longer than usual to bring the children home...?" Angella glanced at Juliet over the rim of her cup. Juliet hesitated a

moment before answering.

"I stayed to talk to Grayskull's parents."

Angella immediately looked worried.

"Is there anything amiss? I know Glimmer was a bit... forceful during the early days of their relationship, but surely...?"

"Everything is fine," Juliet quickly assured her. "Mara, one of her mothers, is a bit of a kindred spirit. We just talked for a while."

First Angella looked surprised, then she sagged in her chair, despite her efforts to hide it.

"Oh..."

"Yeah, she's a fire fighter," Juliet said. "And pretty smart as well. And you know how it is, mothers always need someone to talk to, 'mIright?"

"I guess I have kept you occupied in the house more than is reasonable for me to ask," Angella mumbled, her hand trembling slightly as she tried to hold her cup steady. "Perhaps... perhaps we should look into your scheduling to give you less of a workload during evenings?"

Juliet blinked.

"What? No! My schedule is just fine, Mrs Moon. Besides. When Glimmer brings her friends over more, someone needs to cook for the little rascals."

"I think I can manage..." Angella said, even braving a little smile, despite her visibly tensing at the prospect.

"I have cooked for you since Glimmer started on solids," Juliet said with determined voice. "I'm not stopping now."

"I was not in anyway trying to dissuade you," Angella quickly said. "I just... Juliet, you know I treasure you, don't you? If there is anything in the current arrangements that need to be looked over, you will let me know, won't you?"

"Of course, Mrs Moon," Juliet just as quickly answered. "I'm perfectly happy the way things are."

Only a slight tremor of her voice suggested otherwise.

They both busied themselves with their tea.

"I don't know what I would do without you, Juliet," Angella whispered, keeping her eyes on her cup. "Sometimes I feel that I take you for granted, and I worry that..."

"Luckily, you're never finding out what how to manage without me," Juliet interrupted, "because I'm not going anywhere."

Angella took a long, shivering breath. She leaned forward, as far as she could, and could just place her hand on Juliet's arm.

"Thank you," she whispered.

Juliet shot her a quick smile, which Angella answered after just a moment of hesitation.

They drank their tea.

They glanced at each other.

Juliet licked her lips. She took a short breath.

"Um, Mara... Mrs Grayskull... she actually gave me some advice..."

"Oh?" Angella said, trying to look the right amount of interested.

"She suggested I... work on my... communication skills."

"I have never found you anything but perfectly concise!" Angella protested.

"Well, I'm not always good at articulating things..." Juliet muttered.

Angella quickly scooted closer and placed a cold hand on Juliet's.

"If there is anything I can help you with, Juliet, anything at all, all you have to do is ask."

Juliet hesitated for a moment. She looked into the earnest, violet eyes of her employer. For a moment her face betrayed longing.

Then she smiled, a brave smile that didn't quite reach her eyes.

"I will, Mrs Moon, I promise."

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